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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS), MGU-B.VOC (HONOURS)
REGULAR/IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCE EXAMINATION APRIL 2026
SECOND SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG2DSCENG100 - LITERARY GENRES: PROSE, DRAMA, FILM
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Scheme of Valuation

PART A - MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. c). Brandy [K/CO1]
2. a). The International Literature Festival of Odessa [An/CO1]
3. c) Speaking with an accent [U/CO2]
4. a) It refers to the imaginary barrier between the actors and the audience [K/CO2]
5. b) The Ring and the Book [U/CO2]
6. a) She struggles with the pronunciation of vowels and consonants [U/CO2]
7. b) Isolationism was strong [K/CO3]
8. a) Textual studies [K/CO3]
9. c) Film stock, lighting, camera angle, and editing [U/CO3]
10. d) Higgins's rage and frustration at Eliza's absence and the changes she has caused in his life [U/CO4]

[1x10 = 10]

PART B - SHORT ANSWER
Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11. Chesterton encourages readers to adopt an attitude of cheerful acceptance and imaginative reframing toward life's inconveniences - argues that right mental attitude can transform ordinary mishaps into worthwhile adventures - criticizes modern pessimist tendencies - with the aid of paradox and wit elucidates how the same event can be either a nuisance or an excitement depending solely on perception - ncourages readers to reframe misfortune as opportunity for engagement and embrace wonder at everyday experience. **[A]/[CO1]**
12. Francis Bacon - father of the English essay - introduced essay form to English literature – adapted Montaigne's French model, known for its brevity and compression. Uses quotable maxims ideal for memorization - detached and prescriptive - concerned with universal human behavior rather than personal confession - focus on navigating public and private life successfully - applies scientific empirical observation to human affairs - elevated the essay from a personal literary exercise to a serious instrument of moral and intellectual inquiry.

[U]/[CO1]

13. Act 2 of Shaw's *Pygmalion* - Professor Higgins wagers with Colonel Pickering that he can transform Eliza Doolittle, a Cockney flower girl with coarse speech into someone who can pass as a duchess at an ambassador's garden party within six months - Higgins boasts that through phonetic training alone, he can remake Eliza's speech - The bet is ultimately the engine of the play's moral argument: by treating Eliza as an object of experiment, it exposes class as mere performance.

[K]/[CO2]

14. Language is the primary marker of social class and identity - Shaw uses Eliza's transformation from Cockney-speaking flower girl to seemingly refined lady to expose the arbitrariness of class distinctions - Through her transformation Shaw demonstrates that class is performative rather than essential - Higgins' view of Eliza's original speech as a moral as well as phonetic failing reflects wider social prejudice that associated linguistic difference with inferiority. **[U]/[CO2]**
15. The Three Unities - dramatic principles derived from Aristotle's *Poetics*: (i) Unity of Action – double provision – plot should be either purely tragic or purely comic, but not a mixture of the two (ii) Unity of Time – time over which the plot is spread should be the same or approximately the same as the time of staging the play (iii) Unity of Place – a natural corollary to the unity of time – as the play stages events of few hours, it should be limited to one place **[U]/[CO2]**
16. Invasion of Osterlich is a key episode that satirizes Nazi Germany's annexation of Austria - Hynkel unleashes his aggression toward Osterlich when his request for a loan is rejected - Tomainian troops marches in and takes over, with Osterlich offering no resistance - the ease and absurdity of the conquest satirizes how totalitarian regimes expand through intimidation - world's passive complicity rather than genuine military struggle - invasion ultimately leads to the capture of both the Jewish Barber and Hynkel, setting up the film's climactic finale. **[U]/[CO3]**
17. Music functions as satire, emotional counterpoint, and political commentary - most iconic musical moment is Hynkel's ballet - megalomaniacal fantasies of world domination juxtaposed with delicate, yearning music producing a satirical irony - the music in the background of the Jewish Barber and his dance humanizes the Barber - overall score uses military brass and march rhythms for the Tomainian scenes to parody fascist pomp, while warmer, more lyrical themes accompany the Ghetto scenes - lack of musical underscore in Chaplin's famous closing speech is also critical, improving its emotional weight. **[An]/[CO3]**
18. Colonel Pickering - moral counterpoint to Higgins - Higgins is arrogant, dismissive, and treats Eliza as a scientific experiment, Pickering is consistently courteous, respectful, and kind. - represents the gentleman ideal - educated, well-traveled and genuinely interested in phonetics as a scholarship rather than as a tool for social manipulation - functions as a peacemaker and protector in moments of conflict between Higgins and Eliza - Eliza's famous declaration about Pickering's treatment of her as a lady underlines the relevance of the character. **[U]/[CO4]**
19. Cecil Beaton's costume design for *My Fair Lady* is one of cinema's most celebrated examples of costume as storytelling - Eliza's opening wardrobe - layers of mismatched and drab clothing is a representation of her poverty and social marginalization - Eliza's exquisite black-and-white striped gown paired with a dramatic hat and the white gown for the ambassador's ball are visual representations of her class mobility - costumes in the final scenes reflect Eliza's ambiguous position of being outwardly refined but internally conflicted - Beaton's designs track not just social status but emotional and psychological states of the character throughout the film. **[U]/[CO4]**

[5x6 = 30]

PART C – ESSAY

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. *My Fair Lady* (1964) centres on Eliza Doolittle's transformation from Cockney flower girl to apparent society lady, a journey that exposes class as performative rather than natural. At the Embassy Ball, she passes as a duchess, yet the transformation is fundamentally ambiguous:

Higgins trains her voice, but her intelligence and dignity were always her own. As Eliza insists, it was Pickering's respectful treatment, not Higgins's lessons, that truly shaped her.

However, this mobility comes at a cost. Eliza belongs fully to neither world. She is too refined for Covent Garden, yet still an outsider in the upper class. Her access remains conditional, dependent on male patronage and the exhausting performance of a borrowed identity. The ending undermines her independence: despite her confrontation ("I can do without you"), Eliza returns to a man who never apologized and whose final request for his slippers reinstates domestic hierarchy — surrendering Shaw's feminist vision to romantic convention. **[U]/[CO4]**

21. Since Aristotle's *Poetics*, dramatic structure has been central to literary theory. B. Prasad, in *A Background to the Study of English Literature*, presents the five-stage model comprising Exposition, Rising Action, Climax, Falling Action, and Denouement. The exposition establishes setting, characters, and conflict, but must engage the audience immediately rather than merely deliver information. The rising action, the longest stage, builds complications with causal coherence with each event growing inevitably from the last while revealing character under pressure. The climax is the turning point where tension peaks; it must be earned through preparation to achieve genuine dramatic force rather than mere sensation. The falling action works out consequences at a carefully managed pace, while the denouement resolves all narrative threads. Crucially, Prasad argues that great drama uses this final stage to crystallize the theme — transforming the ending into philosophical revelation rather than simple conclusion.

[An]/[CO1]

22. Drama and the novel both explore character and conflict, but their compositional demands differ fundamentally. Unlike a dramatist, a novelist enjoys almost unlimited freedom enabling a narrator to describe settings, reveal inner thoughts, and move freely across time and place.The most significant difference is the absence of a narrative voice. Everything the audience learns must emerge through dialogue and visible action alone, thus the novelist can afford exploratory dialogue; the playwright cannot waste a single exchange.Drama imposes strict spatial, temporal, and practical constraints, forcing the dramatist toward economy and structural precision. Finally, unlike the novel, a fixed, complete text, a play is always a blueprint for performance producing a different experience every time.

[U]/[CO2]

23. Chaplin's double role in *The Great Dictator* is the film's philosophical core. As the Jewish Barber, heir to his "Little Tramp" persona, Chaplin embodies gentleness, physical grace, and instinctive decency. As Hynkel, he delivers a contrasting performance of operatic excess: his mock-German speeches strip fascist rhetoric of content to expose it as pure theatrical manipulation, while the globe scene reveals the tyrant as a narcissistic child rather than a figure of genuine authority. The double role carries a deeper philosophical argument: persecutor and persecuted are physically identical, insisting that no racial hierarchy has any natural basis. This culminates in the Barber's closing speech, where the victim takes the oppressor's place to speak for human dignity. Though Ebert notes the film softens Nazi violence and the final speech risks breaking the satirical spell, Chaplin's dual performance remains proof that comedy can be one of political art's most powerful instruments.

[An]/[CO3]

[15x2 = 30]